

Body Appreciation Meditation

GUIDED MEDITATION SCRIPT

Date / Time:

So far today, have you brought kind awareness to your:

☐ Thoughts? ☐ Heart? ☐ Body? ☐ None

To begin this Meditation, please bring kind awareness to:

- why you chose this topic
- how your belly, chest, and head each feel when you reflect on this topic
- the emotions that you can associate with these visceral feelings
- the positive or negative impact of any stories you believe in regarding this topic
- the fact that many others are feeling similarly about this topic as you
- how you might feel with increased awareness around this topic
- when you can apply increased mindfulness to this topic in your day-to-day life



Hello and welcome to this meditation. Today I will be guiding you through an exploration of the body, inspiring gratitude as we go along. Please find a quiet place to rest, encouraging your eyes to close when you're ready. (5 second pause)

Resting within your body, take a moment to check in with it – to pause everything and connect. (5 second pause)

Feel the rise and fall of your chest as you breathe...

Following the breath's flow, and noticing the unique rhythm of it. (10 second pause)

Now, take some time to gently disconnect from any mind chatter. Overthinking or scattered thoughts can prevent us from engaging with our physical body.

So, with a few deep breaths, let your thoughts clear. (10 second pause)

Any time you feel your thoughts overwhelming or dominating your mind, gently clear them with each breath out.

If self-critical thoughts arise as we move through the body, see if you can soften or clear these in the same way, or shift your attention to a place that feels easier to hold with appreciation. (10 second pause)

Now, connect with your head, moving into the forehead and the face.

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Consider your eyes and how important they are to you. Note everything that they take in and how they help you identify faces, internalize information, and appreciate beauty.

(5 second pause)

No two pairs of eyes are exactly alike. Your eyes are completely unique, like snowflakes.

Consider the beautiful colors and the intricate dimensions of your eyes, noting how wondrous they are. (5 second pause)

Connect with your ears too, admiring their dynamic shape and their ability to listen, to hear.

(5 second pause)

Out loud or in your mind, repeat, "Thank you, eyes. Thank you ears"; as you sit in appreciation.

(10 second pause)

Connect with the nose and mouth now. Taking a nice deep breath in through the nose and out through the mouth. (5 second pause)

Express appreciation for the natural filtration system of your nose. For the tiny hairs that help filter the air that you breathe. (5 second pause)

Offer thanks to your lips. To your strong teeth. And to the tongue that allows you to enjoy every variety of flavor. (5 second pause)

Repeating, "Thank you, nose. Thank, mouth"; as you sit in appreciation.

(10 second pause)

Moving down the spine, feel the strength of these important bones – the bones that keep your body erect and moving.

Straighten your head, neck, and back as you repeat"; Thank you, spine. Thank you, back"

(10 second pause)

Now, connect with your arms, bringing your attention all the way down to your fingertips.

(5 second pause)

Connecting with the muscles and the delicate bones of the hands.

(5 second pause)

Holding appreciation in your awareness, repeat, "Thank you, arms. Thank you, hands"

(10 second pause)

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Shifting your attention to the chest now. Once again, noticing the gentle rise and fall of your chest and abdomen as you breathe. (5 second pause)

Feel your heart beating in harmony with the rhythm of your breath. Repeating, "Thank you, lungs. Thank you, heart." (10 second pause)

Bring your attention to the abdomen now – to the core of the body. Breathe into it, considering all of the organs that make up your strong core: the stomach and intestines and their many important jobs and functions. (5 second pause)

Repeating now, "Thank you, core. Thank you, stomach." (10 second pause)

Moving down into the legs now. Feel the strong bones here, and the muscles that help you walk. (5 second pause)

Connect with the feet, appreciating every tiny muscle and bone here and repeat, "Thank you, legs. Thank you, feet." (10 second pause)

If you noticed your mind drifting into judgment as you explored your body, take a few moments to return to the areas where appreciation was a challenge – if that feels right for you. Sit with these body parts and allow any and all thoughts to come to the surface. 'Good', 'bad', or in-between. (10 second pause)

Now, clear the mind once again using the breath, creating a blank slate inside of you... making room for appreciation. (5 second pause)

Breathing, clearing away difficult thoughts, any doubts, or negative self-talk, and seeing your body for what it truly is: a remarkable vehicle, a true gift. (5 second pause)

Your body protects you. It nourishes you. It allows you to experience everything that life has to offer. Take a few moments to treasure it, appreciating it for its uniqueness and divine beauty. (10 second pause)

Feel appreciation flowing from the top of the head... flowing down the spine... into the arms and fingers.... (3 second pause)

Spreading through your chest and abdomen... and then down into the legs and feet. (5 second pause)

Feeling your whole body glowing with gratitude. (5 second pause)

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Now, begin to let your breath return to a rhythm that is natural to you. Easy inhales and exhales. Open your eyes when you're ready. Wiggle your fingers and toes and return to your day with a renewed appreciation for your amazing and unique body.

Note: As with all scripts, modify this as it is required to suit your students. For instance, if you are working with people who are visually impaired, you may modify the language used when referring to the eyes.

